

Cycles of Destiny

The composition depicts The Yuen Yuen Institute which is a place of learning Taoism and religious retreat. But it is distinguished by an integrative, all-embracing intellectualism, with its pantheistic approach to religion, including Confucianism. Its non-exclusive stance has become an inspiring perspective for me in composing this work. I felt I was uninhibited by subject matter, style and cultural background and was free to choose whatever I wanted in the treasury of music of East and West, to remix and juxtapose them for a collage that sublimates and develops into something new.

Name of the composition inspires from the middle section of the piece, three non-conducted "Circle Music" are comprised of wind instruments and are requested to provide a sense of endlessness through their progression. As a result, when these three circles are juxtaposed with the conducted music which is formed by bowed strings, a contrasting, crashing as well as chaotic sonic effect with huge tessitura is created. The music enters into climatic section, then ends in a quiet, contemplative manner.